



Separation Support

Premium practice worksheet

SEPARATION SUPPORT - LESSON 05

Build time only when the dog is truly ready.

Use this worksheet to organize short alone-time sessions, progress duration carefully, and make data-based decisions about when to increase, hold, or decrease time.

TRAINER NOTE

Progress is rarely perfectly linear. Calm, repeatable reps matter more than fast increases.

START HERE

Dog: _____

Date: _____

Owner: _____

Best reward: _____

1 What success looks like

By the end of this lesson, the owner can run short duration-building sessions, log body language, and choose the next rep based on the dog's actual performance.

2 Practice plan

1

Start at baseline

Begin with a duration your dog has already handled calmly, not a harder test.

2

Repeat easy wins

Get multiple successful reps before increasing anything.

3

Adjust in tiny increments

Add just a little time when the previous reps looked easy and repeatable.

4

Use the data

Increase, hold, or decrease based on the dog's body language—not owner hope.



Separation Support

Building Alone-Time Duration

3 Supplies and setup

Supplies needed

- ☐ Camera or phone for observation
- ☐ Practice log
- ☐ Safe setup used during assessment
- ☐ A reward or enrichment item if it supports calm

Set up before you start

- ☐ Use the dog's baseline as your starting point.
- ☐ Keep conditions as consistent as possible at first.
- ☐ Plan to stop after a few good reps instead of over-practicing.

4 Departure duration log

Date	Duration	Body language	Reward/setup	Outcome	Next step

5 5-day practice micro plan

Day 1

Set baseline

Find the easiest version and keep it calm.

Day 2

Repeat wins

Practice the same setup until it looks smooth.

Day 3

Add one tiny step

Add only one small challenge if yesterday

Day 4

Hold or simplify

If your puppy struggled, make today easier.

Day 5

Review notes

Choose the safest next step from your log.



Separation Support

Building Alone-Time Duration

6 Common mistakes and quick fixes

Common mistakes

- Increasing duration after a single success.
- Ignoring mounting stress because the dog technically “made it.”
- Making the setup harder and the time longer in the same session.
- Continuing after the dog has already shown clear distress.

If this happens, try this

- If the dog struggled, return to the last easy duration and repeat there.
- If progress feels stalled, review setup, time of day, and whether management is protecting the dog between sessions.
- If the dog does better in some contexts than others, keep training in the easiest context before generalizing.

7 Ready to progress?

- ☐ I am starting from a realistic baseline.
- ☐ I log body language after each rep.
- ☐ I know when to hold, increase, or decrease time.
- ☐ My plan is based on repeatable success, not rushing.

HOMEWORK

Run one to two short sessions per day for five days. At the end of the week, circle the duration that looked easiest and most repeatable, then use that as next week's starting point.

8 Owner reflection

Biggest win: _____

What made it easier: _____

What should I repeat tomorrow: _____

QUESTIONS FOR YOUR FITDOG TRAINER

What should I make easier? _____

What should I practice again? _____

What is the next realistic step? _____